The Martin Family Cookbook

Recipes collected for the 2024 reunion.

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Lemon Bars

Aunt Ruth brought these to every summer picnic.

Makes 16 bars · Prep 20 minutes · Bake 45 minutes

Crust

- 1 cup (2 sticks) butter, softened
- 1/2 cup powdered sugar
- 2 cups all-purpose flour

Filling

- 4 large eggs
- 1 1/2 cups sugar
- 1/4 cup all-purpose flour
- 2/3 cup fresh lemon juice
- 1 tablespoon lemon zest

1. Heat the oven to 350°F and line a 9x13-inch pan with parchment.
2. Beat the butter and powdered sugar until fluffy, then mix in the flour. Press into the pan and bake for 20 minutes.
3. Whisk the eggs, sugar, flour, lemon juice and zest until smooth. Pour over the hot crust.
4. Bake for 25 minutes more, until the filling is set. Cool completely before cutting.

Tip: Dust with powdered sugar just before serving.

Brown Butter Shortbread

Makes 24 cookies

- 1 cup butter
- 2/3 cup brown sugar
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- 2 cups flour

1. Brown the butter in a saucepan, then chill until firm.
2. Beat the butter, brown sugar and salt, then stir in the flour.
3. Roll into a log, chill for 1 hour, slice and bake at 325°F for 15 minutes.

Roasted Tomato Soup

Grandpa Joe's favorite on a cold night.

Serves 4

- 3 pounds ripe tomatoes, halved
- 1 onion, quartered
- 4 cloves garlic
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 2 cups chicken broth
- 1/2 cup heavy cream
- Salt and pepper

1. Heat the oven to 425°F. Toss the tomatoes, onion and garlic with the olive oil on a sheet pan.
2. Roast for 40 minutes, until soft and browned at the edges.
3. Blend with the broth until smooth, then warm in a pot with the cream.
4. Season with salt and pepper.